Fairbanks Football Culture Playbook

Our “Why”

What is the Fairbanks Football program’s “Why”? (Our mission)

The Fairbanks Football program strives to enhance the educational process of each team member by instilling a strong work ethic, good sportsmanship, strong character, selflessness, and a powerful will to succeed in all areas of life, so that each young man will become an extremely productive member of our society as an adult.

What is each individual Coach and Player’s “Why”? - Write it down.

Every team has a culture by design or by default.

We will build ours with toughness, discipline, and love.

Creating a Winning Culture

- It's not just about the X's and O's...
- We want to develop a ***Culture*** that is player driven
- We are about developing our players into quality young men... first and foremost
- We will do this by developing strong leadership skills from within our football program.

Culture: Shared beliefs that drive behavior and the experiences it creates for members of our program.
**Our culture is what we PRACTICE, PROMOTE, & PERMIT!

*Alignment of our Beliefs and our Behavior will create our **DESIRED** culture.

What is our Perceived Culture vs. our Actual Culture

Perceived

Family
Accountable
Great Attitude and Effort
Leadership
Selfless
Winning
Dedicated

Actual

Cliques
Finger Pointing
Blame, Complain, Defend
Not bought into process
Jealousy
Demeaning
Lack of preparation
Unfocused

Are we all in? Do our actions match our words? Does Experience match?

Fairbanks Football Shared Values

ATTITUDE

*You choose and control everyday.

*Positive Mental Attitude - Look for growth opportunity in every situation.

*Is your attitude contagious? Is it worth catching?

"P.M.A."

EFFORT

*Bringing all your talents on a daily basis to everything you do. Never stop, never quit, no matter what.

*Competitive excellence. Compete no matter what. Be Relentess!

"4 to 6, A to B!"

ACCOUNTABILITY

*Doing the right thing whether someone is watching or not.

*Doing your job and fulfilling your role for the team to be successful.

"DO YOUR JOB!"

F.A.M.I.L.Y

*Forget About Me, I Love You

*Servant Leadership

*How did you affect positive change in a teammate today?

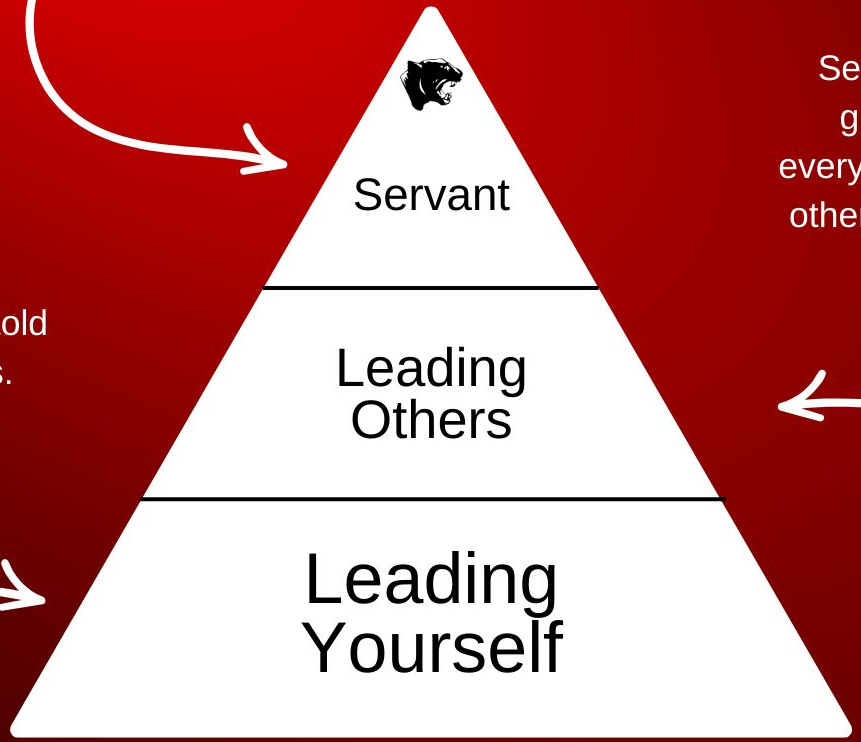
"TEAM FIRST, ME SECOND"

Desired Outcome: Leadership and Trust!

Our “What”?... Leadership within our program

What does it mean to be a **Servant Leader?**

Setting a good example by giving your best effort in everything you do. Encouraging others to do the best they can.



Simply doing what you are told and meeting expectations.

Performance Pathway that leads to success…

Leadership creates culture….

Culture drives behavior….

Behavior produces results!

FAIRBANKS PANTHERS FOOTBALL

A single person can hold the team back. A team will not achieve greatness unless everyone individually chooses to make a change. Individual changes cause mass team change.

“There is a destiny which makes us brothers; none goes his way alone. All that we send into the lives of others comes back into our own.”

-Edward Markham

- Our Core Values fit into the bigger wheel that makes up our
  "Panther Pride Culture"

- These components are what it takes to be great.
  "Water It" "Aim With Everything"
  "Burn Your Goals"
  "DMGB"
  "Step Up"

- We will always expect our players to prioritize themselves in this order:
  1. GENTLEMAN
  2. SCHOLAR
  3. ATHLETE

TRUST

Coaches create culture, athletes grow culture...
Coaches AND players job is to build trust and achieve results

- Must balance trust and results!
  1. Trust without results is unacceptable and results without trust is unsustainable

- The person who determines the level of trust is the other individual whose trust you are trying to earn. *Why? What does that mean?*

- Must deliver an experience to earn others' trust.
  People experience you in 3 ways:
  1. Attitude - feel
  2. Action - watch
  3. Words - hear

***How do you build trust w/ teammates?*

TRUST

People will Trust you (earned, not given by your position) because they have repeated experience of your behavior in 3 categories:

1. Character - Ethical trust, consistent behavior of you doing what you say you're going to do.
2. Competence - Repeated experience of you helping me get better. Do you make me better?
3. Connection - Caring, listening, and connecting with me about what's important to me.

- *The highest levels of performance require the deepest levels of trust.*

We must be strong in all 3 categories of trust to find the greatest success!

Questions about Trust... (Character, Competence, Connection)

1. Which of the 3 areas is the strongest in our program? Which area is the weakest?

2. Which of the 3 categories are you the strongest? Which area do you need to most improve?

3. Which of the 3 areas do you feel your coach is the strongest? Which area do they need to improve?

WHATSAPP

1. Download WhatsApp for your phone.
2. Add Coach Carroll to your contacts **704-609-8960**
3. Send Coach Carroll a message in WhatsApp with your first and last name

LEADERSHIP COUNCIL

You will get a link in WhatsApp to vote. Please complete asap!

Character

Core Values -
Value that is on your heart. Not just on a poster

Courage -
Strength of Heart, strong core values. Not the absence of fear, courage is the presence of fear but the decision to act from your core and your heart because it’s strong. Only necessary when we are uncomfortable, afraid, or uncertain. Courage is what sustains us.

Character -
To stamp or engrave core values onto your heart. Not built quickly or easily. Develop consistency with what we say, who we say we are and how we behave. Repeated acts of courage build character. Repeated acts of lack of courage build character as well. It will be built one way or the other.
Every action builds character - ABC (Always Building Character)

2026 LEADERSHIP COUNCIL

Carson Shope
Reid Phelps
Daniel Bailey
Noah Mullett
Will Stice
Cooper Phelps

Brennan Peffer
Leo Winner
Joseph Hatfield
McClain Burns
Max Winner
Joseph Reinhard

Monday - Character

One Word

Pick a team/school we play and describe their character in one word. When you think of this team, what do you think?

-Not necessarily their talent level (trash, amazing, etc.) but their character. Something they are year after year.

Lourdes - Disciplined

Cannon Falls - Tough

Pick a team and assign them a word.

What one word would someone use to describe the character of the Fairbanks Panthers?

What one word would someone use to describe you and your character?

Do you like the word?

Character

Core Values -

Value that is on your heart. Not just on a poster

Courage

-Returning to your core values, even when it's uncomfortable

- -Football field?
- -School? Classroom? Hallway?
- -Home?

Character -

What do you do repeatedly? Courage or cowardice? It will be built one way or the other.

Every action builds character - ABC (Always Building Character)

CHARACTER

- Everyone watches to see if you follow through on what you say. If you don’t follow through you create a character debt.

- Leading by example isn’t real leadership. Necessary element, but the minimum requirement. Leadership requires you to get more out of people. It’s about what you can get other people to do.

- Lead by example to get their attention, credibility and earn trust. Use those things to make other people better. First lead by example and then lead for real. (***Servant Leadership… What is it?)***

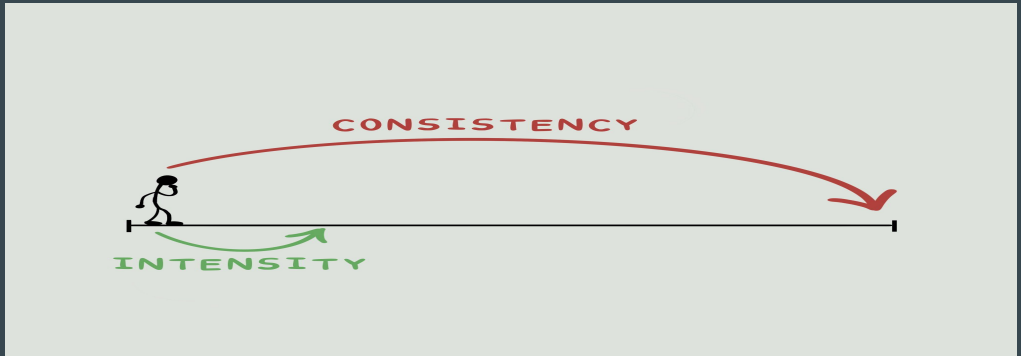
Building Character

Real

- Lead by example (basic)
- Bring out best in others
- Do what you say you'll do
- Values, not emotions

Fake

- Lead for attention
- Inconsistency
- Different each day or around different groups



CHARACTER

Building your Character and getting people to trust your character:

1. Be clear about what your character is or what you want it to be.
2. Be intentional about actually living that character.
3. Be accountable for aligning the behavior and the character you have clarified.

Be clear through your own choosing about what character you want to have. Build your own! This is not someone else's job, it is your job, it is your choice!
You are always building your own house!

- ***What does "Servant Leadership" look like within your position group?***

Build Your Own House

Build Your Own Character

The Builder = You

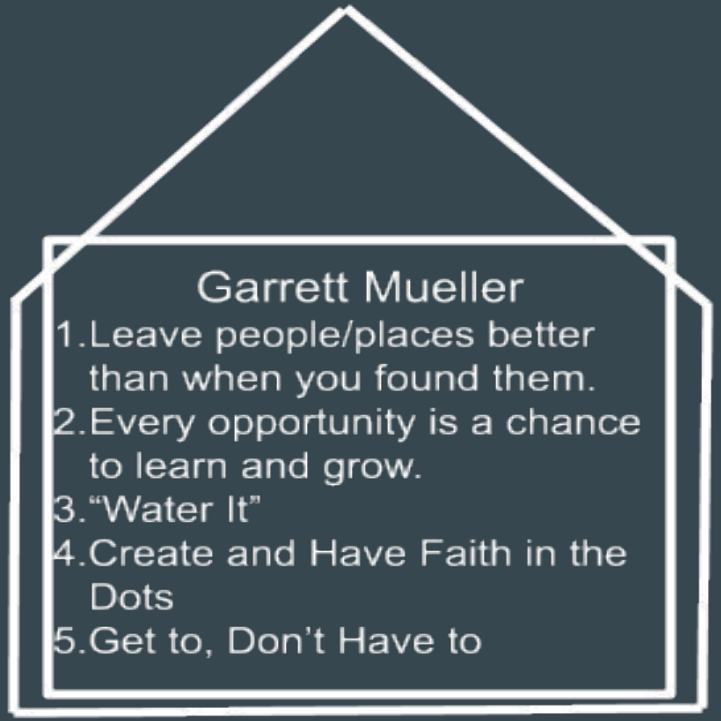
Building a House = An opportunity to show your character

The House = How you act in that situation

The Completed House = How others see your character

What are you building?

BUILD YOUR OWN HOUSE



When will we need it?!

What are You Building?

The Characteristic you want people to think of you:

_____

1. How you'll build it on the field
2. How you'll build it off the field

The Characteristic you want people to think of our football team:

_____

1. How you'll build it in your position group
2. How you'll build it during a game

The Characteristic you want people to think of you:

Dependable

1. Know my job and assignment on every play
2. Show up on time to practice, class, etc.

The Characteristic you want people to think of our football team:

Aggressive

1. Attack each rep like it's a game rep
2. Celebrate like crazy when we make great plays

What are You Building?

The Characteristic you want people to think of you:

_____

1. How you'll build it on the field
2. How you'll build it off the field

The Characteristic you want people to think of our football team:

_____

1. How you'll build it in your position group
2. How you'll build it during a game

Key Takeaways

- You are always building character.
- Your conduct builds character.
- Act with courage, not cowardice.
- Build your own house.

<u>What are you building?</u>

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EFFORT

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Desired Outcome: Leadership and Trust!

BELIEF, BEHAVIOR, OUTCOME

Character Blueprint

(BBO - Belief, behavior, outcome. Guide of how you'll live your character)

1. Define what you believe (What will you have on your core)
2. Define how you will behave for each belief. (Real, actionable, observable behavior)
3. Define the experience your behavior will deliver as well as the outcomes it produces. What do other people get, achieve or experience as a result of you engaging in the behavior informed by a deep internal belief from a character perspective?

BELIEF, BEHAVIOR, OUTCOME

BELIEF "Shared Value"

ATTITUDE

*You choose and control everyday.

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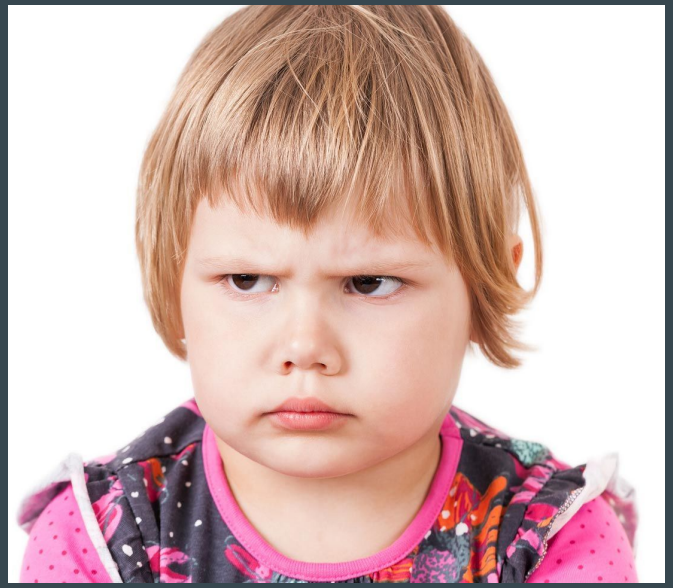
*Is your attitude contagious? Is it worth catching?

"P.M.A."

BEHAVIOR

OUTCOME

Behavior (Attitude) - How can it differ?



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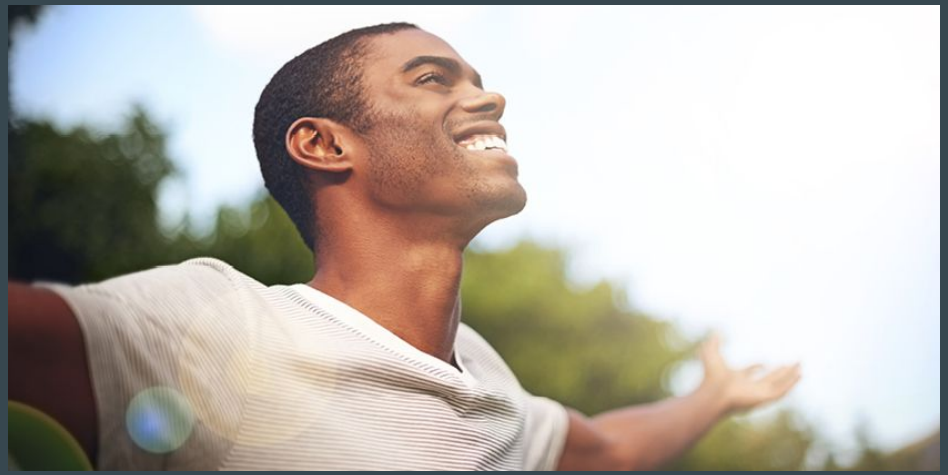

P.M.A. - Allow positivity to produce your outcome!

BELIEF, BEHAVIOR, OUTCOME

BELIEF "Shared Value"

EFFORT

*Bringing all your talents on a daily basis to everything you do. Never stop, never quit, no matter what.

*Competitive excellence. Compete no matter what.
Be Relentess!

"4 to 6, A to B!"

BEHAVIOR

OUTCOME

Effort - Belief is the <u>easy</u> part

Ask yourselves (Behavior)

- Have I given 100% on each play?
- Have I been competing when the opportunity is given?
- Have I been listening to my coaches and teammates?

Your actions, not words, will drive your outcome

BELIEF, BEHAVIOR, OUTCOME

BELIEF "Shared Value"

ACCOUNTABILITY

*Doing the right thing whether someone is watching or not.

*Doing your job and fulfilling your role for the team to be successful.

"DO YOUR JOB!"

BEHAVIOR

OUTCOME

Accountability - What is your role?

BELIEF, BEHAVIOR, OUTCOME

BELIEF "Shared Value"

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*Servant Leadership

*How did you affect positive change in a teammate today?

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BEHAVIOR

OUTCOME

THE PAIN OF DISCIPLINE IS FAR LESS THAN THE PAIN OF REGRET...

Own Your 20 Square Feet

20 sq ft is an analogy of the space you control. You decide what to believe and you decide how to behave.

Team performance is built 20 sq ft at a time. Leadership is helping others perform in their 20 sq ft.

Levels:

1. Team Culture and Strategy
    a. Unit Culture and Strategy
        i. Individual 20 sq ft of belief and behavior (Live it, Own it) - You must live the culture in belief and behavior from your 20 sq ft out because that’s what you can control.

Own Your 20 Square Feet

Eliminate BCD (They have never solved a problem, achieved a goal, or fixed a relationship)

1. Blame
2. Complain
3. Defend (excuse)

Discipline Driven vs. Default Driven Response

Our response to an event is either discipline driven (intentional, on purpose, skillful) or default driven (impulsive/emotional, autopilot, resistant).

Discipline means to teach and to learn. To be committed to a set of principles from which you live.

Without discipline, default takes over.

“R FACTOR”

Event + Response = Outcome

“E + R = O”

The only thing that matters is a DISCIPLINED RESPONSE to the events that happen to us. We cannot control the event, we cannot control the outcome. Surrender the outcome and commit to the process of being great in your DISCIPLINED RESPONSE!

“R FACTOR”

Event plus Response equals Outcome… E + R = O

Outcomes are NOT determined by EVENTS you experience.
What you achieve and produce is determined by how you RESPOND!

Your response is the single most important factor in life! The only thing you control is your response.

If we want exceptional outcomes, we must have an exceptional response!

Disciplined driven response vs. default driven response produces very different outcomes!

“R FACTOR”

What might be some default responses in your position group on the field? What would the impact be to make the switch from default to disciplined?

Disciplined driven responses produce everything we want in life. Default driven responses produce mediocrity, and ultimately lead to failure.

How can you apply E + R = O within Units? Identify in this order...

1. What outcomes are you trying to accomplish?
2. What is the reality of the situation you are dealing with?
3. What would be the most disciplined response you can engage in?

“R FACTOR”

Describe your “R Factor” How strong is it? Do you actively look to improve others and the team through your response?”

We will develop our individual R Factors through discussion and focused practice. Having a disciplined response is a SKILL that you can DEVELOP!

6 Stages of the R Factor Process (Building a Disciplined Response):

1. Press Pause
2. Get your Mind Right
3. Step Up
4. Adapt and Adjust
5. Make a Difference
6. Build Skill

“R Factor” Stage #1: Press Pause

Press pause is all about slowing down impulses. Use time to cycle through and think about E+R=O.

This doesn’t mean to stop entirely, just slow down enough internally. Not always externally. We don’t want athletes stopping in the middle of a performance moment.

The smallest pause can allow you the time to find and focus on what matters.

Pressing pause is a skill. As we develop this skill, performance moments naturally slow down for us, we cycle through E+R=O, and disciplined responses are easy for us to make.

The less skilled we are the longer the pause might need to be. Everyone is different. Take the pause that you need.

Press Pause

Three pause points (what are the impacts of each?):

1. Before an event can occur (proactive pause)
2. Between an event and a response (situational pause)
3. After the outcome (reflective pause)

Pressing pause helps us avoid 3 default traps:

1. Worrying or fixating about an event
2. Gravitate to what is familiar (But might not be what's most effective)
3. Giving up too soon (Must have consistent responses over time to achieve a goal!)

Press Pause

Press pause and ask yourself, “What is the intentional, on purpose and skillful disciplined way I need to be operating right now?”

Must achieve exceptional clarity across E+R=O when you press pause to have a disciplined response.

3 levels of outcomes as a team that we must have exceptional clarity on (All 3 should be aligned):

1. What outcome is our team trying to achieve?
2. What outcomes do you need to produce at your level for your unit?
3. What outcomes are you personally responsible for? (Your 20 sq ft)
   **How does this affect goal setting?*

If these are not aligned, we separate our 20 sq ft and everything else. We focus just on producing what we want, and the team comes later. Or we serve team outcomes, but we do it reluctantly and we are not passionate about them because we aren’t connected to it which leads to sub par effort or performance.

Team, Unit, Me. In that order.

“R Factor” Stage #2: Get Your Mind Right

A disciplined response begins internally and then moves externally.

Internal is mindset and external is action.

Getting your mind right is how to unlock the mental portion that drives the behavioral portion.

All elite performances are unlocked with an elite mindset.

Bring discipline to the mindset so that we can bring discipline into the action and the behavior.

Get Your Mind Right

Mindset Process:

1. Focus - What are you focusing on, what are you paying attention to? This is the key!
2. Self-Talk - What are you saying to yourself, what's on your mind?
3. Feelings - How are you feeling? What's your mental and physical energy?
4. Action - What you decide to do and how you do it.

E + R (Mindset Process) = O

This will create a disciplined mindset instead of a default mindset. What's the outcome of disciplined vs. default mindset on your success? Your teammates success?

A disciplined mindset means you're disciplined, intentional, on purpose, around what feelings you're trying to pull in (focus on), because you're trying to be intentional, on purpose, and skillful in your action.

Get Your Mind Right

Disciplined focus vs. Default Focus (Self-Talk) - this starts with your 20 sq ft and what you control!
How you own yourself matters first!

You choose your self talk, make it whatever meets your needs. However, you must tell yourself a story that actually moves you to do the things that work and start evaluating and removing those stories that don't serve you or your teammates.

Get focused with discipline and intentional stories that drive productive action! Those are the stories that matter and count! Think of a time when you had positive self talk and what was the result? Negative?

When you feel anxiety or other negative emotions about something, have self awareness about what you're focusing on, how you're talking to yourself, how you feel and recognizing the actions you take.

3 parts you have control over:

1. Focus
2. Self-Talk
3. Action

**You cannot immediately control your feelings. Feelings will change by taking control and owning the other 3 steps.

“R Factor” Stage #3: Step Up!

Must be able to Step Up when it matters! Otherwise, why do the work?

Act with discipline or act from default.

Press pause and get your mind right are preparing you to step up… you will be tested often!

Stay focused on you and how you manage E+R=O. The way you step up might be different than others. Control your 20 sq ft. This takes courage!

Courage is what moves you to do the things you know you need to do, but you’re not doing yet.

Q: Think of a memorable time you had to “Step Up” What did it look like? How did you feel?

Step Up!

You must step up:

1. Right now
2. Every day
3. To Predictable Things
4. To Adversity

Q: What are some predictable things in football you will have to "Step Up" to?

Remember, you can only be disciplined in this moment, right now. You cannot step up to tomorrow or yesterday. Be in the moment, win the moment.

Win the Moment has nothing to do with the outcome… it's about owning your response with discipline in that moment. Stack these moments… Build skill, Get better everyday!

You must continually step up every day, every moment. Anyone can step up in a single moment. Greatness requires you to do it consistently. Make this possible this by segmenting…

Step Up!

Break up the day, practice, game into smaller segments that feel more controllable. Easier to control small tasks at once. Don't worry about ALL the things you have to accomplish, just worry about the next achievable task.

Most adversity you will have to step up to in football is predictable… we don't know when they will happen, but we do know it will happen.

Be disciplined in your response and avoid responding on default to the same predictable events you've always experienced and then BCD about experiencing them. Have a predetermined disciplined response!

Q: Think of a time you BCD about a predictable event in football… Did it achieved desired outcomes?
Q: What are some disciplined responses that would achieve desired outcomes to predictable events?

Adversity is an unpredictable event. You will never bring a more disciplined response to an event under adversity and pressure than you have in any other moment up to that point. **YOU WILL SINK TO THE LEVEL OF YOUR TRAINING…** No one performs better under pressure. Under pressure we revert to the most learned behavior we have. This is why it's so important to continually practice E+R=O.

“R Factor” Stage #4: Adapt and Adjust

We must be able to adjust a disciplined response if it ends up NOT being the best for a situation.

It’s easy for us to get locked into our preferred way of doing things. We must be able to adjust behavior skills just like we adjust playing skills.

Everything changes, and we need to be able to make adjustments to our disciplined responses accordingly.

Adjustments are uncomfortable and create discomfort. Those who make the right adjustments will succeed the most.

Adapt and Adjust

Must be able to adjust to changes externally and internally. People stubbornly hold onto less productive methods rather than better ones.

Q: Why do they resist?
It's emotional and personal.

If you're not clear on why you resist change, you will most likely rationalize the causes. This will make dealing with your resistance more difficult. Be aware of the cause. Usually it is fear…

How to adjust and adapt your disciplined response:

1. Responsive - E triggered. Event changes, response changes.
2. Proactive - O triggered. Desired outcome, response changes.
3. Transformative
   ***Any size of adjustment counts. Small or large.*

Adapt and Adjust

Responsive - We cannot be caught responding to an event that has changed without changing our response. New scenario requires adjustments. Cannot get caught being angry at the change in the event. Make adjustments to the new reality! *Example...*

Proactive - We choose to make changes to create new outcomes. There's an outcome we want so we choose our discipline response accordingly to attain something we have not yet achieved. Does your way get results? If not, make an adjustment.

Q: ID change in your disciplined response to bring us closer to our team mission...

Transformative - Less frequent. Most important. Must be willing to adjust yourself. Be open to the transformation you need to make to be the best version of yourself today.

Q: ID transformative change you can make to help become an effective servant leader...

“R Factor” Stage #5: Make a Difference

Relationships are critical to success in life, school or work, and athletics.

Teams fail because people don’t focus on putting enough intentional energy into building relationships. They fail to make a difference for each other and there’s an absence of trust, of a bond, of unity and of alignment.

Everyone and their response is connected! Your response is personal to you, but it’s never private.

Your R is someone else’s E! Your response creates outcomes for other people! Be a GREAT “E” for someone else!

Q: Describe some positive and negative examples or experiences you’ve had with this.

Make a Difference

Create an exceptional experience for your teammates by how you lead, interact, and engage.

3 types of positive AND negative experiences:

1. Forgettable
2. Interesting
3. Exceptional - *Q: What could you do to create an exceptional experience for a teammate?*

Take ownership of your response and the impact (outcomes and experiences) it has on other people.

Take ownership of 3 things and be sure they are aligned! (you control):

1. Attitude (How you make people feel)
2. Action (What people see)
3. Words (What people hear)

Make a Difference

You do not control the experience and the impact of your attitude, actions, and words on others. But you must take ownership of that experience and change/improve it if it does not achieve the desired outcomes.

Be caring - find out what is important to the other person and make it important to you in a way they can feel it. You must OBSERVE OTHERS first to gather this info. This is a choice and then an action.

Be understanding - Listen to understand others' point of view so you are in a position to actually communicate something back that will make a difference.

Pay attention to how you deliver value and outcomes for other people. Make them better, that's leadership!

Be intentional, on purpose, and skillful in how you are contributing to valuable things to OTHER people.

People think various things are valuable. You must contribute value to the other person's scale!
Q: Ask a teammate "what's valuable to you?"

“R Factor” Stage #6: Build Skill

Every Response you engage in is a skill!

Each of your responses are a skill that you can:

1. Practice
2. Teach
3. Train
4. Learn
5. Develop

Worry about your skill in E+R=O first, not someone else’s.

Build Skill

Four levels of skill (This varies within each individual based on the needed response):

1. Beginning
2. Basic
3. Automatic (Talent and experience get you here, often gets trapped here)
4. Exceptional (Talent and experience will never get you here. Requires growth beyond talent)

   Q: At what level is your skill of having a disciplined response?

Exceptional skill requires disciplined driven practice which includes:

1. Mindset - Focus and Self-Talk centered around learning and enjoying the process.
2. System & Mechanics - ID system and mechanics for discipline response (R factor)
3. Repetition & Reflection - Must rep response skills and reflect on success of those reps.
4. Feedback & Accountability - Critical to skill building process because others often see us different than we see ourselves. Others will measure us based on their experience of our actions. If our skill doesn’t produce the outcome we want we must be accountable for improving our response.